



PROGRESS REPORT

Data Storage: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

2 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
Sovereign AI cloud on edge data centres	Did not exist	The operator's AI factory is ranked 36th on the global list of the most powerful supercomputers, presented as evidence that African organisations can train and deploy models on infrastructure sited on the continent rather than abroad; the underlying offer remains AI processing units hosted inside an African edge data-centre network and sold as locally-hosted enterprise AI	ADVANCED
Continental dependence on foreign public cloud	Not held	African artificial-intelligence startups are exposed to hidden financial and operational risk where a large share of workloads sits with a single provider, against which a new generation of African-founded sovereign and low-latency cloud providers is emerging	BASELINE NOT HELD
Data centres the AfCFTA Secretariat states digital trade requires	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 700, against about 220 on the continent, on the Secretary General's statement at Marrakech	Baseline not held
Time for a data centre to reach 85% occupancy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Six to eight years in African markets against two to three in Europe, on the Africa Data Centres Association's 2026 Economic Report, which also puts 80-90% of the continent's data as still processed and stored abroad and projects the market at US\$9.2bn by 2029	Baseline not held

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
Data-centre capacity gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 150MW to 200MW of new capacity — 30 or more large-scale facilities — needed to reach the capacity-to-population ratio of a moderately mature market such as Morocco, on a regional depth of 0.04MW per million people; as at early 2025 the region was the only one on the continent with no established or announced public cloud region from any of the world's five largest cloud providers	Baseline not held

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-01
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/infra-store/infra-store-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/infra-store/infra-store-progress-2026-09-01.pdf
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.